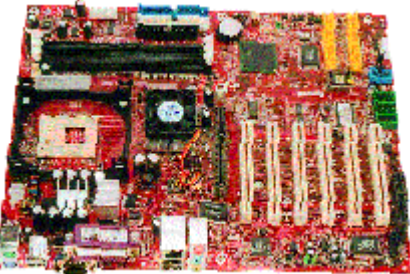


MSI 845PE Max2

A feature-rich and stable performer

This motherboard features a DDR 333 solution based on Intel's latest 845PE chipset, which supports Intel's HyperThreading technology. This allows software



applications to exploit the processor's resources to the fullest by running threads belonging to applications in parallel. However, it requires a CPU that can perform HyperThreading, and Intel has just launched its first such CPU—the P4 3.06 GHz. Also, applications need to be written to take advantage of this technology, so it might be some time before its benefits are actually visible.

The board was tested on a P4 2.8 GHz, with 256 MB of 266 MHz DDR RAM along with a 7,200-rpm hard disk, and a GeForce4 Ti 4600 graphics card on Windows XP. The board performed well in individual tests, though, the overall performance was slightly less than an RDRAM-based motherboard. One area where it showed excellent performance was in the video encoding test, where it encoded a 55 MB MPEG file to the DivX format in just 58 seconds—this means we can expect a better performance when used with the upcoming 333 MHz memory module. This board is excellent for CPU-intensive

applications such as floating point computations. In the Business Creation and in the Content Creation test, the scores were well above your average P4 motherboard.

The board is armed to the teeth with features. It has six-channel sound capability with an onboard AC'97 5.1 sound decoder. The motherboard supports a maximum of 2 GB of DDR RAM with three DIMM slots. A Gigabit Ethernet controller is also integrated. Another interesting feature is the presence of an onboard Promise RAID controller with RAID 0 as striping and RAID 1 as mirroring. The board comes bundled with a USB 2.0 module with diagnostic LEDs. This helps in debugging system problems without opening the case. Also included are an IEEE 1394 module, an S/PDIF (Sony/Philips Digital Interface) module, four detailed manuals and a driver and software CD that contains Live Update, a BIOS updating software for Windows and PCAlert4, a diagnostic utility that gives information about various system parameters and displays a warning when the threshold limits are crossed.

SPECIFICATIONS
845 PE chipset with HyperThreading technology, DDR 333 support, onboard AC '97 5.1 channel support, IEEE 1394, Gigabit Ethernet, Promise RAID controller, 4x AGP, 6 PCI slots, 1 CNR slot, USB 2.0 module

Price: Rs 9,000
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MSI 845PE Max2		B+
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶▶	

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